```
  module Y
    module Z
    end
  end
end
M = X::Y::Z

X::Y::Z.parent # => X::Y
M.parent       # => X::Y
```

If the module is anonymous or belongs to the top-level, `parent` returns `Object`.

Note that in that case `parent_name` returns `nil`.

Defined in `active_support/core_ext/module/introspection.rb`.

3.3.2 parent_name

The `parent_name` method on a nested named module returns the fully-qualified name of the module that contains its corresponding constant:

```
module X
  module Y
    module Z
    end
  end
end
M = X::Y::Z

X::Y::Z.parent_name # => "X::Y"
M.parent_name       # => "X::Y"
```

For top-level or anonymous modules `parent_name` returns `nil`.

Note that in that case `parent` returns `Object`.

Defined in `active_support/core_ext/module/introspection.rb`.

3.3.3 parents

The method `parents` calls `parent` on the receiver and upwards until `Object` is reached. The chain is returned in an array, from bottom to top:

```
module X
  module Y
    module Z
    end
  end
end
M = X::Y::Z

X::Y::Z.parents # => [X::Y, X, Object]
M.parents       # => [X::Y, X, Object]
```

Defined in `active_support/core_ext/module/introspection.rb`.

3.4 Constants

The method `local_constants` returns the names of the constants that have been defined in the receiver module:

```
module X
  X1 = 1
  X2 = 2
  module Y
    Y1 = :y1
    X1 = :overrides_X1_above
  end
end

X.local_constants    # => [:X1, :X2, :Y]
```